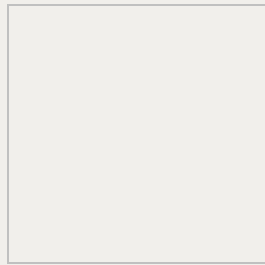


IN CONTEXT

Folk Music

Grieg's interest in folk music was closely aligned to the nationalist movement that was leading his country toward independence. The initial stimulus sprang from his friendship with the composer Rikard Nordraak and was reinforced in 1869, when he came across Ludvig Lindeman's collection of folk melodies. Filled with enthusiasm, Grieg set about producing his own arrangements of these, publishing them as 25 Norwegian Folk Songs and Dances, Op. 17. He continued to draw inspiration from this type of material for the rest of his career, culminating in the lively *Slåtter*—piano versions of peasant fiddle-tunes. In these, Grieg mimicked the double-stopping technique of the traditional Hardanger fiddle.



HARDANGER FIDDLE: WOOD, EBONY, MOTHER-OF-PEARL, BONE; 1786

Edvard Grieg's family had Scottish roots. His great-grandfather, Alexander Greig, arrived in Norway in the 1760s, when he changed the spelling of his last name to Grieg. He settled in Bergen, on the west coast, where his family soon flourished. Edvard's father, John, held the post of British consul, while his mother, Gesine, was the daughter of a provincial governor. Both parents were highly musical, so Edvard was encouraged to develop his skills at an early age. Gesine gave him piano lessons